

Leo W. Gordon

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Summary

Expert in magnetic resonance & electrochemical methods.

I have expertise in applying magnetic resonance and electrochemical methods to study energy materials. My primary interests centre around investigating ion transport and reaction mechanisms mechanisms in electrolytes and membranes.

Education

The City College of New York

PHD - CHEMICAL ENGINEERING

MPHIL - CHEMICAL ENGINEERING

New York, NY

2018-2023

University of Edinburgh

MCHEM - CHEMISTRY

Edinburgh, U.K.

2012-2017

Experience

Danish Technical University - Department of Chemistry

Kongens Lyngby, Denmark

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR - MAGNETIC RESONANCE AND ELECTROCHEMISTRY LAB

2025 - Present

- Principal investigator of the Magnetic Resonance and Electrochemistry Lab
- Operando NMR methodologies for studying ion transport in battery and membrane systems
- NMR and electrochemical method development to understand charge storage and transport mechanisms across different lengthscales
- Sustainable processes for recycling and resource recovery using ionic liquids

University of California, Santa Barbara - Materials Department

Santa Barbara, CA

POSTDOCTORAL SCHOLAR - ADVISOR: PROF. RAPHAËLE J. CLÉMENT

2023 - 2025

- Determination of ionic diffusion through polymeric materials by applications of pulsed-field gradient and electrophoretic NMR measurements
- Studying both partitioning behaviours and transport processes in multi-phasic systems using spatially-resolved NMR techniques
- Designing apparatus for *operando* NMR transport measurements in membranes
- Probing ion-ion and ion-solvent interactions via their coupled diffusion, as compared to equilibrium models of ion dissociation
- Mentoring and teaching graduate students and facilitating NMR and electrochemistry training

The City College of New York - Department of Chemical Engineering

New York, NY

PHD CANDIDATE - ADVISOR: PROF. ROBERT J. MESSINGER

2018-2023

- Applying advanced solid-state NMR methodologies to establish ionic and electronic charge storage mechanisms in quinone electrodes for aluminum batteries
- NMR characterization of molten-salt electrolytes in liquid and heterogeneous samples to develop understanding of reaction processes following electrochemical cycling
- Quantum chemical calculations to determine thermochemical viability of ion generation pathways and quadrupolar NMR parameters of electroactive ions
- Evaluating reaction schemes via NMR to characterize the modification of LiPF_6 by P_2O_5 for long-life and low hysteresis lithium-metal batteries
- Investigating chalcogen electrodes for rechargeable aluminum batteries, studying the impacts of structure at different length-scales to the resultant reactions
- Understanding a novel non-intensive recycling process for lithium-ion battery cathodes by NMR analysis, in combination with complimentary techniques

Awards & Fellowships

GRANTS

2026 DTU Alliance Fellowship, DTU/EPFL
2026 Conference Participation Abroad, Otto Mønstedts Fond
2025 Start-up Grant, Torkil Holm Fond

HONOURS

2024 Quantum Foundry Postdoctoral Associate, California Nanosystems Institute, UCSB
Heeger Travel Award, Materials Research Laboratory, UCSB
Rising Stars of Materials Science & Engineering, Stanford University
2022 Travel Award, The Electrochemical Society
Twitter Conference Poster Award, Global NMR Discussions
Travel Award, Rocky Mountain Conference (RMC) on Magnetic Resonance
Travel Award, Experimental Nuclear Magnetic Resonance Conference (ENC)
2020 Grove School of Engineering Fellowship, The City College of New York
2019 Acrivos Fellowship, The City College of New York

Teaching Experience

Spring 2022 Chemical Engineering Thermodynamics I, Teaching Assistant
Spring 2021 Chemical Engineering Thermodynamics I, Teaching Assistant
Fall 2020 Chemical Engineering Thermodynamics II, Teaching Assistant
Spring 2020 Chemical Engineering Thermodynamics I, Teaching Assistant

Outreach & Professional Development

SERVICE AND OUTREACH

2025-Present Vice-chair, Danish Electrochemical Society
2023-2025 Organizer, UCSB NMR Seminar Series
2024 Volunteer, MRL Outreach
Summer 2024 Entrepreneurial Lead, NSF I-CORPS
2021-2023 Treasurer, Electrochemical Society Student Chapter
2019-2020 Treasurer, Graduate Student Council, CCNY

PEER REVIEW

Polymer	Advanced Energy Materials
ACS Sustainable Chemistry & Engineering	Advanced Materials
Journal of Physical Chemistry	
Chemistry of Materials	Small

Publications & Patents

PUBLISHED

- [1] Olivia A. Wander, Anaya Khan, Euan N. Bassey, Tyler Pennebaker, Harrison Szeto, **Leo W. Gordon**, Neva Luthria, Oscar A. Nordness, Yangying Zhu, and Raphaële J. Clément. Impact of diglyme cosolvent on low-temperature microstructural lithium growth. *ACS Applied Energy Materials*, 9:3525–3537, 3 2026.
- [2] Oscar Nordness†, **Leo W. Gordon†**, Zidan Zhang, Venkat Ganesan, and Raphaële J. Clément. Disentangling cation effects on ion mobility and structure in ionic liquid electrolytes. *JPhys Energy*, 8, March 2026. † authors contributed equally.
- [3] Parham Ghasemihangarani, Donovan del Mundo, Ryan C Chow, Gabriel Farhan, **Leo W Gordon***, and Theresa Schoetz*. A tutorial for the identification and quantitative disentangling of charge storage mechanisms by variable-rate cyclic voltammetry. *Electrochimica Acta*, page 148127, March 2026. * co-corresponding.
- [4] James T Bamford, **Leo W Gordon**, Raphaële J Clément, and Rachel A Segalman. Converting a metal-coordinating polymer to a polymerized ionic liquid improves Li⁺ transport. *ACS Macro Letters*, 14:87–92, November 2025.
- [5] Thomas R. Webber, Declan P. Shannon, **Leo W. Gordon**, Oscar A. Nordness, Joshua D. Moon, Raphaële J. Clément, Benny D. Freeman, Rachel A. Segalman, Craig J. Hawker, and Songi Han. Solution-like water transport across molecular to macroscopic length scales in crosslinked poly(ethylene glycol diacrylate) networks with tailored sidechains. *Journal of Polymer Science*, 63:3990–4002, October 2025.
- [6] Nico Marioni, Akhila Rajesh, Rahul Sujanani, Zidan Zhang, **Leo W. Gordon**, Raphaële J. Clément, Rachel A. Segalman, Benny D. Freeman, and Venkat Ganesan. What is the Role of Relative Humidity on Conductivity in Polymer Electrolytes? *ACS Macro Letters*, 14(6):865–871, June 2025.
- [7] Evangelia Founta, Marina Carravetta, Michael Thielke, Ana Belen Jorge Sobrido, **Leo W. Gordon**, Themis Prodromakis, Carlos Ponce De León, Dimitra G. Georgiadou, and Theresa Schoetz. Understanding Charge Storage Mechanisms in Flexible Nanocellulose/Graphite Battery Electrodes. *ChemElectroChem*, page 2500096, May 2025.
- [8] Seongkoo Kang, Jihyun Kim, Youngju Choi, Suwon Lee, **Leo W. Gordon**, Euan N. Bassey, Jean-Claude Badot, Olaf J. Borkiewicz, Olivier Dubrunfaut, Raphaële J. Clément, and Yong-Mook Kang. Controlling Interlayer Disorder Toward Reversible Phase Transition in a Layered Sodium Manganese Oxide Cathode. *Journal of the American Chemical Society*, 147(8):6665–6678, February 2025.
- [9] James T. Bamford, **Leo W. Gordon**, Raphaële J. Clément, and Rachel A. Segalman. Converting a Metal-Coordinating Polymer to a Polymerized Ionic Liquid Improves Li⁺ Transport. *ACS Macro Letters*, 14(1):87–92, January 2025.
- [10] Rahul Sujanani, Phong H. Nguyen, **Leo W. Gordon**, James T. Bamford, Alexandra Zele, Benjamin J. Pedretti, Nathaniel A. Lynd, Raphaële J. Clément, and Rachel A. Segalman. Influence of Water Sorption on Ionic Conductivity in Polyether Electrolytes at Low Hydration. *ACS Macro Letters*, 14(1):64–71, January 2025.
- [11] Harrison Y. Asare, Surabh S. KT, **Leo W. Gordon**, George John, and Robert J. Messinger. Effects of ion mass transport on electrochemical reaction pathways in aluminum-anthraquinone batteries. *Electrochimica Acta*, 507:145031, December 2024.
- [12] Jonah Wang, Theresa Schoetz, **Leo W. Gordon**, Elizabeth J. Biddinger, and Robert J. Messinger. Ternary Ionic Liquid Analogues as Electrolytes for Ambient and Low-Temperature Rechargeable Aluminum Batteries. *ACS Applied Energy Materials*, 7(13):5438–5446, July 2024.
- [13] **Leo W. Gordon†**, Rahul Jay†, Ankur L. Jadhav, Snehal S. Bhalekar, and Robert J. Messinger. Elucidating Consequences of Selenium Crystallinity on Its Electrochemical Reduction in Aluminum–Selenium Batteries. *ACS Materials Letters*, 6(7):2577–2581, July 2024. † authors contributed equally.
- [14] James T. Bamford, Seamus D. Jones, Nicole S. Schausser, Benjamin J. Pedretti, **Leo W. Gordon**, Nathaniel A. Lynd, Raphaële J. Clément, and Rachel A. Segalman. Improved Mechanical Strength without Sacrificing Li-Ion Transport in Polymer Electrolytes. *ACS Macro Letters*, 13(5):638–643, May 2024.
- [15] Theresa Schoetz, Loleth E. Robinson, **Leo W. Gordon**, Sarah A. Stariha, Celia E. Harris, Hui Li Seong, John-Paul Jones, Erik J. Brandon, and Robert J. Messinger. Elucidating the Role of Electrochemically Formed LiF in Discharge and Aging of Li-CF_x Batteries. *ACS Applied Materials & Interfaces*, 16(15):18722–18733, April 2024.
- [16] Oi Man Leung, **Leo W. Gordon**, Robert J. Messinger, Themis Prodromakis, Julian A. Wharton, Carlos Ponce de León, and Theresa Schoetz. Solid Polymer Electrolytes with Enhanced Electrochemical Stability for High-Capacity Aluminum Batteries. *Advanced Energy Materials*, 2303285(14), January 2024.

- [17] Brendan E. Hawkins, Theresa Schoetz, **Leo W. Gordon**, Surabh Kt, Jonah Wang, and Robert J. Messinger. Reversible Zinc Electrodeposition at $-60\text{ }^{\circ}\text{C}$ Using a Deep Eutectic Electrolyte for Low-Temperature Zinc Metal Batteries. *Journal of Physical Chemistry Letters*, 14(9):2378–2386, March 2023.
- [18] **Leo W. Gordon**, Jonah Wang, and Robert J. Messinger. Revealing impacts of electrolyte speciation on ionic charge storage in aluminum-quinone batteries by NMR spectroscopy. *Journal of Magnetic Resonance*, 348:107374, March 2023.
- [19] Atanu Roy, Theresa Schoetz, **Leo W. Gordon**, Hung-Ju Yen, Qingli Hao, and Daniel Mandler. Formation of a CoMn-Layered Double Hydroxide/Graphite Supercapacitor by a Single Electrochemical Step. *ChemSusChem*, 15(21), November 2022.
- [20] **Leo W. Gordon**, Ankur L. Jadhav, Mikhail Miroshnikov, Theresa Schoetz, George John, and Robert J. Messinger. Molecular-Scale Elucidation of Ionic Charge Storage Mechanisms in Rechargeable Aluminum–Quinone Batteries. *The Journal of Physical Chemistry C*, 126(33):14082–14093, August 2022.
- [21] Jian Zhang, Jiayan Shi, **Leo W. Gordon**, Nastaran Shojarazavi, Xiaoyu Wen, Yifan Zhao, Jianjun Chen, Chi-Cheung Su, Robert J. Messinger, and Juchen Guo. Performance Leap of Lithium Metal Batteries in LiPF_6 Carbonate Electrolyte by a Phosphorus Pentoxide Acid Scavenger. *ACS Applied Materials & Interfaces*, 14(32):36679–36687, August 2022.
- [22] Rahul Jay, Ankur L. Jadhav, **Leo W. Gordon**, and Robert J. Messinger. Soluble Electrolyte-Coordinated Sulfide Species Revealed in Al–S Batteries by Nuclear Magnetic Resonance Spectroscopy. *Chemistry of Materials*, 34(10):4486–4495, May 2022.
- [23] T. Schoetz, **L.W. Gordon**, S. Ivanov, A. Bund, D. Mandler, and R.J. Messinger. Disentangling faradaic, pseudocapacitive, and capacitive charge storage: A tutorial for the characterization of batteries, supercapacitors, and hybrid systems. *Electrochimica Acta*, 412:140072, April 2022.

IN REVIEW

- [1] N. Shojarazavi, **L.W. Gordon**, J. Zhang, Y. Fu, H. Pazooki, C. Hung, D. Jiang, J. Shi, R.J. Messinger, J. Guo. Aluminometallurgy for Lithium-Ion Battery Recycling.
- [2] N. Shojarazavi, **L.W. Gordon**, H. Pazooki, R.J. Messinger, J. Guo. Aqueous methods to recover and purify metals from lithium-ion batteries treated with chloroaluminum reagents. [Patent Filed.]

Presentations

INVITED TALKS

ECS Seminar, University of California, San Diego

“Combining Magnetic Resonance with Electrochemical Methods to Understand Mechanisms in Energy Systems,” 21 July 2026, *La Jolla, CA*.

CRMN Seminar, ENS Lyon

“Partitioning and Diffusion Measurements using in-situ NMR Spectroscopy,” 11 September 2025, *Lyon, France*.

Chemistry Departmental Seminar, Danish Technical University

“NMR Methods to Elucidate Electronic, Ionic, and Transport Mechanisms in Battery and Membrane Systems,” 22 May 2025, *Kongens Lyngby, Denmark*.

Center for Polymers and Organic Solids Seminar, University of California, Santa Barbara

“Studying Electrochemical Reactions in Organic Electrodes and Transport Mechanisms in Polymer Membranes by NMR Spectroscopy,” 30 April 2025, *Santa Barbara, CA*.

Quantum Foundry Seminar, University of California, Santa Barbara

“NMR Methods to Elucidate Electronic, Ionic, and Transport Mechanisms in Battery and Membrane Systems,” 14 March 2025, *Santa Barbara, CA*.

Chemical Engineering Departmental Seminar, University of South Carolina

“Membranes and Megawatts: Revealing Mechanisms with NMR Spectroscopy,” 30 January 2025, *Columbia, SC*.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Experimental Nuclear Magnetic Resonance Conference

“Deconvoluting Li-ion Battery Electrolyte Speciation Through Large-Bandwidth Decoupling,” 12-16 April 2026, *Asilomar, CA*.

Danish NMR Meeting

“NMR Methods to Measure the Impact of Cation Identity on Ion Transport and Solvation Environments in Ionic Liquid Electrolytes,” 29 January 2026, *Horsens, Denmark*.

Danish Electrochemical Society Meeting

“Unveiling Mechanisms in Batteries from the Molecular to the Macroscopic Scale with NMR Methods,” 6-7 November 2025, *Kongens Lyngby, Denmark*.

Experimental Nuclear Magnetic Resonance Conference

“Measuring Partitioning and Diffusion Across Interfaces using Temporally and Spatially Resolved NMR Spectroscopy,” 6-10 April 2025, *Asilomar, CA*.

American Institute for Chemical Engineers Annual Meeting

“Application of Advanced Magnetic Resonance Methodologies to Elucidate Charge Storage Mechanisms and Ion Interactions for Energy Storage Systems and Beyond,” 27-31 October 2024, *San Diego, CA*.

Southern California Users of Magnets Conference

“Spatially-Resolved NMR Methods for Investigating Partitioning Behavior,” 26 October 2024, *Los Angeles, CA*.

Experimental Nuclear Magnetic Resonance Conference

“Spatially-Resolved NMR Methods for Determination of Solute Partitioning,” 7-11 April 2024, *Asilomar, CA*.

Experimental Nuclear Magnetic Resonance Conference

“Impacts of Electrolyte Speciation on Ion Binding Environments in Aluminum-Quinone Batteries Elucidated by Dipolar-Mediated and Multiple-Quantum Solid-State NMR Methods,” 16-20 April 2023, *Asilomar, CA*.

Battery & Energy Storage Conference

“Impacts of Electrolyte Speciation on Aluminum-Organic Battery Charge Storage,” 26-28 October 2022, *New York, NY*.

Electrochemical Society Meeting

“Understanding Improved Lifetimes of Lithium-Metal Batteries LiPF₆ Carbonate Electrolyte Modified by Phosphorus Pentoxide,” 9-13 October 2022, *Atlanta, GA*.

Global NMR Twitter Conference

“Electrochemical Complexation of Polyatomic Aluminum Ions to Heterogeneous Organic Electrode Samples Investigated Using Solid-State Dipolar-Mediated NMR Methods,” 3-5 August 2022, *Virtual*.

Rocky Mountain Conference on Magnetic Resonance

“Electrochemical Complexation of Polyatomic Aluminum Ions to Heterogeneous Organic Electrode Samples Investigated Using Solid-State Dipolar-Mediated NMR Methods,” 25-29 July 2022, *Copper Mountain, CO*.

Experimental Nuclear Magnetic Resonance Conference

“Molecular Structures of Reaction Products in LiPF_6 Carbonate Electrolyte with a Phosphorous Pentoxide Scavenger for Rechargeable Lithium Metal Batteries,” 24-29 April 2022, *Orlando, FL*.

American Institute for Chemical Engineers Annual Meeting

“Charge Storage Mechanisms of Quinone- & Flavin-Type Organic Electrodes for Rechargeable Aluminum Batteries Elucidated with Molecular-level Specificity,” 7-12 November 2021, *Boston, MA*.

Electrochemical Society Meeting

“Electrochemical Complexation of Polyatomic Aluminum Cations in Quinone-type Organic Battery Electrodes Revealed by Solid-state NMR,” 10-14 October 2021, *Virtual*.

Experimental Nuclear Magnetic Resonance Conference

“Molecular-level Insights into the Charge Storage Mechanisms of Rechargeable Aluminum-Indanthrone Quinone Batteries Revealed by Solid-state NMR Spectroscopy,” 29-31 March 2021, *Virtual*.

Battery & Energy Storage Conference

“Molecular-level Investigation into the Charge-storage Mechanisms of Rechargeable Aluminum-organic Batteries,” 21-23 October 2020, *Virtual*.

Electrochemical Society Meeting

“Molecular-Scale Understanding of Charge Storage Mechanisms in Organic Positive Electrode Materials for Rechargeable Aluminum Batteries,” 4-9 October 2020, *Virtual*.

Battery & Energy Storage Conference

“Rechargeable Aluminum Batteries Using Organic Cathode Materials with High Cycle Life and Capacity,” 21-22 October 2019, *New York, NY*.